



Seychelles blue pigeon

Found in the dense forests on many of the country's islands, this pretty pigeon feeds on tropical fruits.

Capital of the islands
The capital city of Victoria on Mahé Island has leafy palms and a mix of architectural styles, including the Victoria Clock Tower, which was built in 1903.



Aldabra Atoll is a group of four large coral islands on the outer edges of the Seychelles.



Aldabra giant tortoise
The Aldabra Atoll is home to this rare tortoise. It can weigh up to 550 lb (250 kg) and live for 150 years.



Mahé Island



- 176 sq miles (455 sq km)
- 96,000
- Victoria
- French Creole, English, French



An archipelago of 115 granite and coral **islands** off Africa's east coast, the Seychelles were settled in the 18th century. The continent's **smallest nation**, it has a diverse population and is known for its **beaches** and **reefs**.

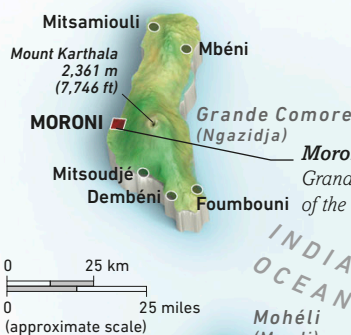


Sweet fragrance

The scented yellow flowers of the ylang-ylang tree grow all year round in the Comoros islands. They are used to make perfumes and essential oils.

Decorative clothes

Comoran women traditionally wear dresses called shiromani. These colorful, patterned fabrics are worn draped over the body, together with head scarves.



A paste of sandalwood and coral, called msinzano, is used to decorate the face.



Comoros



Grande Mosquée de Moroni

Muslims gather for daily prayers at this 19th-century mosque. Many Comorans are of Arab or Persian descent.



The **three volcanic islands** of **Comoros** in the Indian Ocean are known as the "**perfumed islands**" because of the abundant **fragrant tropical plants**. The trade in **spices** such as **vanilla** and **cloves** has brought **people from many continents** to settle in Comoros.

- 863 sq miles (2,235 sq km)
- 846,300
- Moroni
- Arabic, Comorian, French